

Department of the Interior Industry Day

Meeting Recording (link: https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=G8_p1BI7sRA)

March 27, 2026, 3:30PM; Yates Auditorium in Main Interior Building, Washington DC

Transcript

[Tyler Kellogg] Ladies and gentlemen, we'll begin in about one minute.

Well, good morning, everyone. Hopefully the trip in was nice. I'm sorry it rained today. It's a shame the cherry blossoms are almost in peak bloom right now. My name is Tyler Kellogg. I serve as the advisor to the Secretary and on behalf of Secretary Burgum and the Department, welcome to our Department's Industry Uniform Day. We're genuinely grateful that you're all here in this room. We have colleagues from across the DOI bureaus, the Army Corps of Engineers, fellow federal agencies, and partners from our Made in America Office, and businesses who came today because they believe this effort is worth showing up for. That means a great deal to us. And again, thank you.

Just something personal before I begin. I served nine years in the active duty and continued to serve in the National Guard. Today, every time I put on that uniform, I am incredibly proud to wear it. Part of that pride comes knowing that I was made by American hands. That's not a small thing to me and it is a point of honor, so when I tell you the Department is serious about this effort, I'm not just speaking as a policy official, I'm speaking as someone who's worn a uniform for most of his adult life and who believes the people who serve this country deserve to be outfitted by the country they serve. That conviction extends to every uniformed employee of the Department. Rangers officers, fire crews, wildlife biologists and law enforcement agents. The men and women who stand watch over America's public lands from the rim of the Grand Canyon to the shores of the Chesapeake every year, the Department spends millions on uniforms that employees wear. That is a significant investment of taxpayer dollars, and the Department has made a deliberate decision about where those dollars should go. That decision is grounded in clear direction from the President and his management agenda.

The US government is the single largest buyer of goods and services in the world. That is extraordinary leverage and this administration plans to use it intentionally. On its first day back in August, the President signed the America First trade policy, directing agencies to maximize domestic procurement. Earlier this month, the president signed a new Made in America Executive Order reinforcing that

commitment and making it clear that when this government says it's buying American, it means that vision. [To be] straightforward, federal procurement dollars should not simply buy products. They should rebuild industries and when the American government buys American, it sustains American factories, American jobs and American supply chains. DOI's contracting office is just one small piece of that larger effort and we intend to do our part.

The Department is acting on that direction and we are establishing, within all applicable laws and regulations, a new procurement vehicle designed to increase domestic sourcing of uniforms and textiles across all of our bureaus and that more than anything is why we are here today. We want to understand why American industry can deliver and what they can deliver, what you make, what your capacity looks like and how we can structure a solicitation that gives domestic manufacturers a real path to winning this work. Let me be direct. We do not want to inadvertently write requirements that favor foreign procurement. If the way we've been buying uniforms has made it more difficult for domestic manufacturers, we want to know that today and what we can do to fix it.

We have displays on the floor that you can see following this meeting about what our bureaus need, their field uniforms, their dress uniforms, outerwear and ancillary items, and we're going to walk through those items together. We're going to examine whether any of those existing specifications are inadvertently pushing the acquisition away from domestic suppliers. That is a question we intend to answer before we scope the solicitation. We have contracting officials here who can speak to the requirements in detail. We will set aside time for one-on-one sessions so you can have a direct conversation with us and our contracting leaders.

Here's what we are asking for you to do today. Engage with us, honestly. Tell us what you can do, what you can't do, tell us what your capacity is and if there are structural barriers standing between American manufacturers and this contract, we want to know because the goal is not to hold an industry day - the goal is to award a contract that puts American made uniforms on American federal workers. President Trump's administration is committed to this and to speak to that commitment directly, on behalf of the Made in America Office, I am pleased to welcome Michael Stumo.

[Michael Stumo] So the Buy America Act was from 1933, Berry [Amendment] not that long after. And I got into my position last year and it was astounding. I mean, I kind

of knew, but how non-compliant the government had been [with] various Buy America laws, so right now we're cutting through the thicket of the barrier between our procurement and buying American. And really appreciate Tyler and Greg Washer [?] and Secretary Burgum and the whole team for leading the way on the Interior side, which of course is not governed by Berry [Amendment]. Ideally, I'd like to see, you know, the whole of government buy USA made uniforms; textiles, that is. You know we are and will be making progress on that. We need you to keep pushing us, keep pushing across agencies, but for the, you know, the Border Patrol is wearing uniforms made in Honduras. Secret Service making uniforms made in Southeast Asia. It's, you know, once you actually know, you can't unsee that, right? When I got here, the White House gift shop. My deputy is Joanna Wischer; she is not here today but she came in and said it's all Chinese. And we went in there. There's a building I work in the Eisenhower Executive Office building is a little gift shop. You can get some, you know, like a cup and some, you know, you know what you get in gift shops and there's nothing made here. And actually I had gotten a call from The West Wing on that. That's how it came about. And then Joanna went and did research and took pictures. And we found the folks that, you know, buy the stuff for the gift shop. Said, you know, this is like White House logos on it's approved. You got to get the logo approved. You got to, you know, you got to keep with the branding, the IP, all that made in China underneath. What about all that detail? And what about that part? Well, I didn't know where, you know, Where do we get it cost and all that sort of thing? But they've the guys actually of Navy and the Marines sort of run the White House Navy mess and you know the gift shop too? And so the guy, you know, he was not resistant, he was just befuddled. How do we do it? So we got some, I think Kim Glass helped get some, where's Kim? Got some names of some suppliers that make these shirts, make the cups, make the hat, whatever and so it's represented to be all USA made in the White House Gift shop, which is nice. It doesn't put, you know, you all the work, but it's sort of indicative. I've got one of the first cups that came out-of-the-box. They were very proud and actually, and once you cut through the thicket of buying American; once they get there, at least the procurement people I talked to are kind of proud of it. It's kind of fun. Wow, we accomplished something, but you start out and Oh my gosh, you know, everything is efficiency and economy of procurement. Lowest cost, acceptable quality, right? And that's hard wired. That's how they're trained. That's how they get, you know, their certifications. And that's how of course, there's budget considerations too, we see. Unreasonable

fears of excessive cost usually when they haven't looked in it, there's a fear of more cost than there is in some cases, depending on the product, there's none, of course there's the quality side too. Helping our procurement officials through from you know, my side and your side, there are more tools than Berry [Amendment] to do these things. You can... the solicitation, the RFP can include other requirements from quality to geographic to you know, presumably resiliency. I don't think we've fully explored all of that. But there's also, Tyler, Industrial Mobilization authorities, and this is an industry the President has designated as an important industry. And there you can do your research and decide this is what we're doing to mobilize industry. It's easy. It's in the Federal acquisition regulations. It should not be abused to reward your brother-in-law, but for this; Is something that is quite efficient. And then it sets aside some of those other rules, but I know. I don't know all of you or most, but I know there's a lot of underutilized capacity here. There's a lot of room to grow with existing capacity. And I know there's a lot of room to grow with existing production. And so as I think you know, I am a warrior for you and I want this to work and I know that other agencies are coming around. They're looking at this, more than looking. They're active, so keep pushing. Interior is blazing the trail with Tyler's leadership. In doing this, which really I don't know if it's been done, you know, at Interior for, when? And so it's not always fun being the tip of the spear with all the other considerations sometimes, but with your support keep pushing. I know sometimes in the past you've gotten kind of depressed about the progress. But now there's reason for optimism and we will get this done. Thank you.

[Tyler Kellogg] Now we're going to move into our procurement update.

Slides are on the final pages of this transcription.

[Michelle Yates] Good morning. It is a good morning, right? Good morning. I want to first introduce myself. I am Michelle Yates. I am the Chief of Contracting for DOI. We support NPS, and I want to introduce Sarah Welch. She is a CO that's helping on the uniform contract and we also have Jaime Mijares, a lot of you might know her or heard her name, she's also a CO, and we have Nancy [Lewis] here, she is our solicitor that is helping us with this acquisition, so, if we can start the slideshow. Thank you, Tyler.

Okay, so as many of you may or may not know, this describes our IDIQ, our current uniform contract. It's an IDIQ which means indefinite delivery, indefinite quantity

type contract. It was solicited as a full and open competition with a subcontracting plan, which means we work with other contractors. It was solicited under FAR Parts 12 and 15, which some of you, I know you're very well versed in those chapters of the FAR in FY22. It is a firm, fixed priced [contract] and we have task orders based on employee allowances like in [National] Park Service. The employees get an allowance, we do bulk orders of specific items and it's currently almost 1000 individual items and it's \$130 million IDIQ ceiling that goes over five years.

I do want to talk if we go the next slide. I'm sorry. I'll tell you the next slide. Sorry, it's impromptu. Here are the participants that are currently on this IDIQ - National Park Service, can I have you [stand up]? There, that's Ramie [Lynch], bear with me, Jaime., I'll say names too. So if you do the CORs, because I'm still learning names, we also have Bureau of Land Management – Karrie [Davin].

We have Bureau of Reclamation – Anika [Johnson], I'm sorry. I know your name, I just get nervous.

Bureau of Safety and Environmental Enforcement - John, thank you and

U.S. Army Corps of Engineers - Heath [Kruger] and then

US Park Police – Jonathan Hofflinger; yep, there he is, there's a beauty queen wave and then we have US Fish and Wildlife – Wade [King], love your wave.

So those are our participants.

I know some other bureaus are looking at maybe possibly a participating in the future acquisition. Next slide please.

As you can see by the table, NPS has the most uniformed employees. We have about 12,000 full-time, 8,000 seasonal and about 420 worldwide park units.

BLM has 4,000, which is 195 offices.

BOR has 300.

BSEE has 20.

USACE has 2,600 permanent and 1,200 seasonal.

USPP has 700+ law enforcement and I think is growing at this point.

USFWS has about 6,500, including full time and seasonal [employees].

So in each Bureau there are a variety of uniform categories. For example, NPS has a Class A dress uniform for the Park Rangers, and you can see examples of that over here (I think Park Service is over here) and then Class B for less formal occasions at work, uniforms worn by trail crews and maintenance workers, law enforcement and specialty items etcetera which are on display over there. Each one of these includes their own components from head to toe for summer and winter. As you know, some

of our park units are in Alaska all the way down to the desert. A portion of each seasonal workforce is new or new each year, and they have to be completely outfitted. A small portion of the uniform items are used for more than one Bureau, but many of these still require customization, such as adding identifying patches. On next on the next slide, I'll mention some of the challenges and work environments that we experience in these bureaus. Sorry, sorry. OK. Employee duty stations. Bear with me, I'm a little nervous as I just explained. We have extremely cold, cold climates such as Alaska, Montana and North Dakota, and we'll say South Dakota too. An extremely hot desert such as we know the Mojave Desert. Tropical climates like Florida, Caribbean and American Samoa and Virgin Islands. Remote and very remote areas for delivery. And that require a modern, flexible approach to fabrics, patterns and finishes. I think at the time when you're going around to the COR tables, talk with those bureaus, probably a little more about their products and Jaime can answer some of those questions too. I guess I should slow down, I talk kind of fast. Let me know if I need to slow down. Next slide please.

Here is the DOI uniform requirement. The current award provides for full service, one stop shop for civilian uniforms, patches, insignias, headwear, footwear, outerwear related items, and customizations for each Bureau, program and contract management, product inventory management, uniform service operations such as sourcing, first article testing, warehousing, knitting, shipping and customization and customer service. So that's basically what we go through with the current contract. Next slide please.

The uniform requirement the current IDIQ requires the contractor to provide a secure website for uniform ordering and account management system - WBOS that has processes such as orders, returning exchanges, cancellations, adding and replacing or selling discontinued items as needed; payment from employee allowances (a lot of bureaus give the employees allowance every year and those are authorized through task orders against the current IDIQ), government charge cards, and personal charge card and debit cards. It also does reporting for us. Next slide.

So the task order management, how that works against the current IDIQ, currently in pricing period 4. It's a five year ordering period and it ends September 27th, 2028. US FWS and BLM typically use multiple task orders. NPS, USACE, and USPP typically order one task order each year. And BSEE and BOR typically issue item-specific task orders. [Next slide.]

Industry Day objectives - our objectives today. So we want to have an open

exchange of ideas and industry patterns; Seek industry expertise to help understand and refine requirements; Ensure strategy promotes and robust fair competition; Address industry questions and concerns; Obtain market knowledge for this requirement. Next slide please.

In conclusion, DOI contracting intends to hold one-on-one virtual meetings with interested companies in the near future. Stop by the contracting table after the break for more information regarding this. The panel discussion is open forum and seeking industry input. Industry questions will be answered to the best of our participants' current understanding of the plans, objectives and general solution. No information will be contractually binding. OK. And we also, like I said, we're looking forward to talking to you. Please come up with questions and do understand that this is market research for us. This is us seeing what the industry is looking for and what we're looking for too. Next slide.

Here comes the disclaimer. OK, market research. This is only market research for us. This participation panel discussion is for market research purposes only. This is not a solicitation and does not constitute a request for proposals, quotes or bids. The government is not obligated to award a contract based on this information. Any information provided by industry is voluntary and will be used to inform acquisition planning. The government will not reimburse any costs associated with attending this industry day. Responses may be used to help determine acquisition strategies, small business participation and Buy American considerations. Thank you. All right. Thank you everyone. We have to say the rules.

[Tyler Kellogg] A little loud right there could be turned down a little bit. That's perfect. Good afternoon, I'll be the moderator for this. Turn it down just a little bit, it's a little loud. Just discussing why we're here today overall, I mentioned it before, it's providing insight to us. Contracting is very complex. I'm not a contract officer. I was a research analyst for two years for Army DoD procurement. That being said, I'm not a subject matter expert. That's why we've assembled subject matter experts in the room. So we're going to focus on a couple key areas today and we ask that you guys provide us questions, feedback overall, and we have some questions that I believe we've posted on SAM.gov so that you could hopefully provide some feedback to us for, so just some of the items we're going to focus on today. So, Made in America requirements - what are they, the draft performance work statement, feedback, pricing structure, sourcing, and product specifications, and

ordering systems, and timelines. The goal, like I said in my introductory remarks, is to understand what your capabilities are, what your constraints are, and your limitations are to help inform our acquisition approach. So first, starting off with Made in America requirements overall, I'd like to open up to the room. Are there any initial questions from the introductory remarks or feedback from the audience? Sure. Of course. Actually we have mikes over here too. State your name where you're coming from, your organization, too, before your question. That'd be fantastic.

[Jackie Ferrari] Sure, I'll stand. I'm Jackie Ferrari from American fashion network. I know a lot of you here, some I don't. My question is, would you consider doing this by category - like shirts and then pants, because a lot of the factories don't do both. So I feel like if it's not separated or there isn't an option in there for a separation that you're going to knock out some really good participants that could do one or the other.

[Tyler Kellogg] So we're here for open engagement too, that's great to see from the, that's fantastic for us to know by the uniform type and items based for the different bureaus, would that be the, like, pants? For a vehicle or how do you see that going to be the most beneficial for?

[Jackie Ferrari] I think it would be most beneficial to have, you know, like your button down shirts. You know, I don't think it has to be like across all of your agencies. I think that really we can manage how you buy it; I mean, the beauty about American manufacturing; of course, everybody loves long, deep runs. But the beauty of what we do here for serving the government for so long is we can do small batch and I think we do that better than any country in the world. So I think it has to work for how you buy it, but it just would be a nice option that if you have a shirt factory and they are exceptional at shirts, they shouldn't be left out because you put a solicitation out as a shirt and a pant [contract]. So I think really depending how you guys do it, how it works best for you, but just to keep that in mind so that all factories can participate.

[Tyler Kellogg] inaudible question/comment

[Jackie Ferrari] I mean small batch could run 300 pieces to, you know, 300,000 pieces. I mean I will tell you I represent factory; so I am not a factory, I represent a lot of factories for both the commercial space and the government space, and you know, like I said, of course we want the longer runs, but sometimes for survival you have to work in these small batch arenas, but there's a lot of capacity out there and I would

say really on the short side from a sewing perspective, when it comes to fabric, that's where you can bundle. So really you kind of, you know, I would hope you could look at it in two different ways, sewing can do what you need them to do. Fabric - You have dye lots that you have to go by; usually it's 3,000 yards, the fabric people can tell you, but you know you have to really stick within a certain yardage for dye lots, so they're not as efficient with small batch, but it's the batches can be smaller than you think. They don't have to be huge. Sure.

[David Costello] Thank you, I'm David Costello, Warrior Protection Readiness Coalition. I just want to thank you all for doing this. I feel like I'm dreaming. We've been hoping for this day for years and years and years, and it's remarkable to see something like this coming together. Our association captures the entire supply chain from initial input of fiber materials all the way to the end item, be it a uniform or body armor or helmets. And related, Tyler, thank you for your service. Appreciate that and your service continues. Here my question is kind of twofold. You showed the scope of the current contract runs through 2028. Is the intention to make a change before that contract runs out, or do you have to wait until it ends and the second part of my question is, is the notion here that you want to reflect the Berry Amendment type of requirements in what you will buy so, fiber forward so, you are buying as American as possible all the way 100% from fiber forward is what the Berry Amendment achieves. So I'm curious if that's the intention. So thank you.

[Michelle Yates] Sorry about that. The end date actually is 2027, so this is why we're doing our market research right now. As we procure because usually this type of acquisition can take up to a year for us to do a new one. So you know we're, that's why we're doing this now. So we can see what the market is.

[Gary Nederawa] Yeah. Hi, Gary Nederawa, Greenwood mills. We're weavers of fabrics. As you were saying, the current Army and all of the services now give out top or bottom contracts. Usually it's not the whole outfit, so I don't, I see that it would be possible to do it that way. You just have to know you're ordering this right. Same amount if you're giving them to different vendors. The question I have is the contracts that you're going to, the solicitations, you're going to be putting out is going to have a the Buy America requirement on it?

[Tyler Kellogg] Is that to [me]? There we go - it's [the mic] working now. So in my introduction is within all applicable regulations and policies right now with the US government too, and what Mr. Stumo here said was, there are tools that we can use and we're analyzing those tools right now. Industrial mobilization is one we're looking into, but there are new avenues of approach that we could take here to encourage in more of a domestic sourcing requirement. But the contract vehicle, it's currently in the process of being developed. So there are things that we can use to encourage domestic production. And correct me if I'm wrong Nancy as well.

[Gary Nederawa] Right. Because you know, Berry is a congressional law. And without that, it's going to be, unless you put this has to be Buy America now Buy America, the end use has to be made domestically, but 65, 35% of the item can be sourced. So my fabric is probably less; US fabric is probably less than 65% of the end use item cost, most of it is in the labor of the manufacturing of the garment. So I know it's going to 75% in 2028 I believe, but that's still going to probably keep the weavers, the domestic weavers, out because the manufacturers are going to try to bid the lowest they can and they're going to look to source the fabric and if they can source that fabric from overseas cheaper, they're going to do it.

[Michael Stumo] That percentage requirements, cost of components, it's not labor, it's not other stuff. It's cost of components, correct?

[Gary Nederawa] Correct.

[Michael Stumo] OK.

[Gary Nederawa] Well, I think it's total cost of the end use item. So if the end use, if you're buying,

[Michael Stumo] If the content requirement is the Buy America outside of Berry is assembled here, final assembly plus the cost of components; it excludes non-goods inputs for that calculation, so labor, labor, marketing, none of that stuff is included. Now if you buy, if you buy in a component that is priced because it has labor in it, that's fine, but it cost the components is what it says. They cost a good ...

[Gary Nederawa] So the cost of the manufacturer to assemble that garment is not part of that cost, part of that percentage.

[Michael Stumo] A physical item that was bought and incorporated into the product is included, but for that final assembly to include labor, as part of that percentage. No, their own labor.

[Tyler Kellogg] Just before the next question too, just for our introductions, I know you've met myself and Mr. Stumo, but just want to go through the panel right now and just do a quick introduction between all of us.

Tyler Kellogg, Advisor to the Secretary of the Interior, focusing on Interior's Buy American efforts.

Michael Stumo, OMB Made in America office and Economic Policy Office.

Hi, my name is Nancy Lewis, I'm the Assistant Solicitor for the Branch of Acquisitions and Intellectual Property.

And I'm Michelle Yates. I am the Chief of Contracting under the Department of Interior, servicing National Park Service contracts and my ConOps, we support national programs and all the parks here in DC. So that's our role and of course the uniform contract funds falls under my organization.

Sarah Welch, my job title is Contract Specialist.

Jaime Mijares, Contract Specialist as well.

[Michael Stumo] I'm going to ask a question I neglected to say. The president's management agenda, which the president releases a management agenda every year, it's by statute, actually and Tyler alluded to it, but it says the words are very important for this. The president's management agenda, it's usually 50 pages. Actually it's one page and on that page includes the words rebuilding industry through maximizing Made in America procurement. So it's not like grudging basic compliance with, you know, Made in America laws, it's maximizing it and to rebuild industry and so that means that where there is sufficient government demand to actually make a difference in industry, it's not with paperclips, it is with uniforms. It is with medical goods. You know, we're paying attention to that. And it also includes how not just what we buy, but how we buy. and so that's a prelude to the question that it's my understanding from past dealings with you all that a fixed price term contract. And I'll just say to the acquisition people here, so that means we consider the industry health as well as, you know, economy and efficiency of procurement, it is balancing that. Those longer term, a solid demand signal over actual demand over years, so that you all fill capacity, you have stable employment, you're able to invest in even you know more improvements, not only helps you now; helps you get cheaper financing and helps you with the CapEx so that you can get even more efficient in the future. Let's get a couple comments on that please, to what extent that's helpful; maybe it's not helpful.

[Kim Glass] Hey, Michael, you hit the nail on the head. I'm Kim Glass. I'm the President and CEO of the National Council of Textile Organizations, deeply grateful to the Made in America Office and the Interior team today. You have no idea how long our industry has been hoping for a phone call that we received from Tyler that you all were going to put this together and we hope that through the engagement with all of you we can demonstrate to you we can make a fully Made In America uniform at a competitive price and meet the goals that we all mutually want to meet. And I'm so grateful a lot of our DLA partners are in this room. We are key suppliers to our U.S. military of over 8,000 different products, so please know we can make a uniform.

We can make all sorts of uniforms and we want to, I want to hit a couple things, both on what Michael said. The industry is running at 50 to 70% capacity. 50 to 70% capacity. So the urgency for us on Interior Department and quite frankly every other agency across the government to buy fully more Made in America product from the fiber stage all the way to the finished product will not only help our supply chain resiliency for our Defense Department but also will help this great industry in rural communities across this country that are the primary tax base, so we want to partner with you as quickly as humanly possible to achieve this. The second thing is, Michael, you've hit some of the constraints in the past. You know, sometimes our industry is faced with short lead times or small batch order and not a consistent demand signal over time so you end up hiring a bunch of workers and then laying folks off when that demand goes away. I think that just looking at your presentation today, understanding the number of employees, you have a fairly consistent demand level. I mean, you have the same relatively the same number of uniforms every year. So if you're issuing through the market research longer term contract, longer term order horizons, that's a great signal to our industry: Go invest. Go invest in your factory and your people because that demand signal is here. And you know, I think the fault of some of the Buy American which we, you know, obviously a lot of folks supply and Buy American products here, is it doesn't benefit absolutely everybody and we have a lot of idle capacity here that could truly benefit. So thinking about that, thinking about how to make sure you're giving the volume help, that's helpful to the industry, you know, but our industry stands ready to work with you. This is so very important to us and hopefully as engagement that you're having with us, you can spread to other agencies like DHS, like the VA hospital system saying, you know,

this is working over here. So we want to work, we want this to work for all of us, so that's all I have to say.

[Michael Stumo] I'm just going to follow up on that because I did, we did have, you know, somewhat of a, you know, many of you were there, but not all of you, you know, a sit-down with DLA on similar issues last fall. Similar issues came up about this and DLA, as I understand, had not given you know sort of those longer term contracts with a consistent demand, even though DLA did have consistent demand - Army, Navy, Air Force, Marines, all that, there is a, you know, every year it's within a margin that kind of demand; if that as opposed to an IDIQ or something and you know there were some procurement hiccups where you have a whole spike of orders and then down and I mean try running the Interior like that, where you got a spike of work and then you just, you know, have to like, well, you know, go home, or maybe you won't come back. Congress does that to Interior and us both. But you know, but DLA in that case. So I think they've sorted or have started sorting that out. They came to, you know, makes sense. And so as a company that has these, you know the orders, if you don't know what's coming, you can't go to a lender, you can't get covered. You don't have a lender story to you know, cover the gaps. If you have that, actually I found out in the medical space because we're kind of doing the same thing for like personal protective equipment or trying to. Essential medicines which we actually have more capacity than you would think in this country. And they have been demanding government money for, you know, demanding or requesting, you know, at various times. But shoot, if they have a solid demand signal, there's virtually unlimited, you know, capital lending, you got a story for the lender. You can upgrade. You can keep current. You can fill. You know, obviously if you're full your per unit cost is a lot less. And so I just wanted to sort of share those stories that it can, you know, be very helpful with contract design to have that you know very steady demand so whoever is involved can use that to you know, for, for financing, for stability of employment, stability of the workforce, train the workforce, and the workforce has confidence that they are going to have a job and don't have to go, you know, become a Frappuccino server next week at no notice and can upgrade and keep, you know, keep, you know, keep the equipment current and a dialogue ahead of far as what are the needs, so that there is a lead time to sort of in some cases, equip for whatever particular requirements there is and to learn from industry, hey, there's some new stuff that you might want to consider that you didn't really know

because you're not in the industry and we are, and here's, you know, some cool stuff is where things are going and you might want to incorporate that. So I'll thank you.

[Jackie Ferrari] So thank you, Mr. Stumo. I think you said something really great with contract design and I had the privilege of being at that DLA meeting and I can tell you that I have seen a dramatic difference in the way that DLA is approaching their purchasing. We just had JAPBI and it was there was an energy in the room that I have not ever seen. So I can tell you thank you, that I think that event was really telling and I do see it. You know, I would ask you, DOI, to be open to contract design, so to getting to know the vendors who are going to stand up and say I want to do this and to get you what you want, this is what I need. Because what Mr. Stumo was saying is financing is a huge part of this. And IDIQs are the death of a small business. So you know, until you get into the system and you figure out how to how to do it and how to make it work. But we are a small family of manufacturers. America is a small family and really we collaborate well and work really well together. And you know, if we can have that open dialogue with you and know your needs and then go back to the sewers, go back to the people who are supplying the fabric and all of that and work together to be successful for you. But really, you know, kind of ponder that contract design comment because that's really what it takes and it's what exists in industry and that's going to make this successful across all of these different agencies.

[Nancy Lewis] What do you envision?

[Jackie Ferrari] Sitting down with your supplier and saying I need 35,000 shirts over the course of the next three months, and what do you need from me to get that done? So it's a two-way conversation.

[Michael Stumo] Aren't you talking over years, though? Like 3. You know you don't want just a three month contract.

[Jackie Ferrari] No, I'm just saying, like, when things come up? Yeah, like having

[Michael Stumo] What's the duration of the contract that you envision being? You know, it is common elsewhere?

[Jackie Ferrari] At least five years. If it's capital improvement though, if it's to expand a factory here, or to build a factory here, I definitely think it needs to be 7 years at least. But five years at the very, very least because you can't get financing with something that's not secure.

[Michael Stumo] What other terms would you suggest?

[Jackie Ferrari] Well, I think that the way the DLA pays in 15 days is super beneficial to every supplier. I think that they also have terms that are 30 days. I would not go over that, but that 15 days is a really, really big benefit and sweet spot.

[Michael Stumo] Anybody else? Contract terms? Recommendations, sir? Over here first.

[Paul Pinto] Paul Pinto, I'm with Milliken. When you get to the fabric level, you start talking about on the fabric side, the longer lead times are very helpful because if you think about it, you've got to really go from thread to weaving to finish fabric. So all that is additional lead time. So three months to make a fabric, it might it'll be within a window, might be six months, but you've got to make that fabric and then it's got to go and get cut and it's got to get sewn. And we've run into, very recently, situations where you've got manufacturers cutting and sewing, but they've run out of some of the other supplies they need like, say, zippers on a coverall. So we've got fabric, [but] they can't take it. We made the fabric to their orders. They can't take the fabric because they have no zippers to put their coverall together, so now they're forced to lay off people because they can't cut and sew because they don't have any zippers. So we've been trying to, we try to be very flexible and work with a lot of manufacturers to say, keep you out of [trouble], keep the fabric coming, maybe make the coverall so you don't lay anybody off and then when the zippers show up, catch the zippers up. But then they've got financial needs as well, right? They've got to pay for fabric they've ordered. They've got to keep people working, so again, the longer that lead time is, the more ramp up time you can keep people running, and running consistently. Then they can make those investments so they can keep that business running.

[Michael Stumo] But that wouldn't be Interior's problem necessarily except the lead time and that would give the prime vendor and the supply network the space to solve those issues so they could deliver as expected, right?

[Paul Pinto] Correct. Yep.

[John Colleran] Sir, good morning. I'm John Colleran with the CN Clark company. So we do a high durability fabric label that's sewn into most of the uniforms procured by DLA. Building off their 0% prompt pay for 15 days flow down to subcontractors, prompt pay for subcontractors would be just absolutely incredible as well. On the point about Buy America and percentages, so some of us here are in the kind of the

trim space, if you will. Again, I do a label. I think there's some folks here that do patches and emblems, thread, zippers. I would encourage you to maybe investigate performance requirements. So for example our label is incredibly durable, incredibly strong. You can take upwards of 600-700 lbs per square inch on some of the burst tests. So again, if you're looking to try to provide an opportunity for Berry [Amendment] compliance, one thing that we can kind of take from, cross-pollinate from the DLA world is performance standards. So you know some of us again in the trim space might be kind of left behind when it comes to Buy American Act. But if you're looking for again high durability stuff, you by default kind of land with us. Thank you.

[Michael Stumo] That brings up the total cost of ownership point, which is actually, you know, in manufacturing is one thing, the price of ownership starts with the price you buy something in. But there's a cost of ownership is the durability, the returns, and all that sort of thing. I don't know, if, I'll ask my colleagues here is the total cost of ownership concept common or used in procurement now?

[Michelle Yates] Not always, it just depends on what we're procuring. It does bring in and Nancy could probably, brings in a lot more locality and sometimes copyright, so we have to be kind of careful of that. I'm just generalizing and stuff...

[Michael Stumo] Just something to consider, we don't need to resolve it here, but that's how you know there are hidden costs of other things going on besides the price. The Chinese sent it to, you know, quoted you...

[Michael Stumo] Any other contract...? yep.

[Andrew Nagle] So probably not how to write the contract. My name is Andrew Nagle with Conrad Industries in western North Carolina and we make embroidered patches. So when you look at a uniform, we're the first thing you see and so Buy America does not help us at all because they're not making the patches in the United States. So you mentioned Customs and Border Patrol, the uniforms made in Honduras. Well, the patches probably made in China, OK. So we need Berry [Amendment], absolutely, Berry. And we're a prime DLA supplier and they struggle to enforce, so enforcement's tough. We need enforcement. We're getting ready to meet with the Berry Amendment caucus next month on enforcement and it has to start there. If you don't do Berry, it's OK. You're not going to help the patch guy, for sure. I didn't mention

fabrics. It's got to start fiber forward, right? So embroidery threads made in Mount Holly, NC, in Pennsylvania, you know, the fabric for the new Army AGUs, you know Burlington Mills, all of that, all those components, half the tumble, and then you've got to think of an enforcement component because it's easy to cheat. Like we're full of cheaters. The embroidery business, the insignia business is horrible. You know, I can buy thread made in China, have two embroidery machines and stitch in it in my garage. And you'll go, yeah, they make it in the United States. So we need your guys's help and what you're doing, we're so thankful, is Berry and then we need to work with, we need to work as industry with the Berry caucus and figure out if they're going to put money to enforcement or it's just fake, right? It's yeah, either Made in the United States, but they're not. So we appreciate you guys tremendously and it's huge. And if you ever want to come see where the patches for the astronauts are made, our patches just headed to the moon and are going to circle the moon. So NASA buys made in America. You know, they don't have to, but they do. So thank you for doing this. We appreciate it.

[Michael Stumo] Does anybody know what NASA? If you have a contact for NASA, I'm sure our DOI friends would like to see what they're doing too and learn.

[Jessica Sweet-Proulx] Hi, my name is Jessica, I'm from SMP in Massachusetts. We are responsible, one of the few manufacturers that do the metal work, so we represent the insignia realm which you know, we're an ant compared to everything else we're talking about on uniforms. But along with what he's saying, the industry is full of cheaters and there is no accountability for it and we are constantly going up against what you guys consider to be reasonable pricing, but against what standard? What standard is reasonable when there are people with four employees, five cars in the parking lot, claiming to make everything from scratch, and they're selling it at pennies on the dollar compared to what domestic manufacturers are actually able to make it for and we are prime manufacturer for DLA as well, and we've brought this up to them and their response has basically been well, you know, give us proof. It's like, well, you're the US government.

[Michael Stumo] You brought it up to who?

[Jessica Sweet-Proulx] Defense Logistics Agency, the contracting officers.

[Michael Stumo] OK, let me know when you find evidence of this stuff, let my office know.

[Jessica Sweet-Proulx] Well, I think that's kind of the point, is

[Michael Stumo] There is an EO that's recent that focuses the President. You may have seen it, a recent executive order on false labeling of goods, including goods sold to the Government.

[Jessica Sweet-Proulx] OK.

[Michael Stumo] And there's two remedies. One is to refer them for False Claims Act at the DOJ, but of course, that's nothing against DOJ, but they got a lot to do, it's very helpful to focus on that. But the other is that they're pulled from government acquisition and that's where my office can be helpful. Getting the assertion to the right place and you start getting people pulled for not managing the supply chain and making false claims. So just, for everybody to the extent you see that you know, my office is newly relevant for that.

[Jessica Sweet-Proulx] OK. Awesome. And also in regards to the IDIQs, we had a five year contract that we got in goodness 2019 I believe, for service ribbons, but 2021 came around and obviously we all know what COVID did to the economy, and we were not able to hold that price. There was absolutely no way at all that we could hold the price and there was there was zero despite everything that the industry had gone through. I mean the world obviously, but there was no considerations for whether or not it was reasonable to expect us to hold a pre-COVID price. So we had to back out of the five year contract and then we they then got held against us for future acquisition opportunities. So you know those types of considerations and IDIQs would definitely help domestic manufacturers from our perspective.

[Jaime Mijares] So the way the current requirement is written is a total source. I know we do like the ordering - the employees can order off of it, as well as customization and like it's a total service, warehousing, ordering and I heard a lot about like the fabrics and that part. But is that a barrier for most of the companies here - it being a total source with the web-based ordering site and also like I said, the customization with the patches and that, in that area?

[Jack Cravy] My name is Jack Cravy. I'm with a company called cart.com. The Cart Government Solutions is subsidiary of that and I help in business development and I actually run a software division where we specialize in web order management platforms that you're talking about, right? In fact, we're about 60 days from launch for a DHS web portal that is almost identical to everything that you're asking for here

for ICE agents across the country. So we're familiar with security standards. These requirements at a scale similar to yours, if not more. And I have some questions. So as you know, like agents ordering products through the web system typically contains PII because it's agent information, it's agent name, which is considered CUI. So the requirements you're asking for sounds like a federal system which would require FISMA moderate, which would need an ATO to be able to do based on NIST 853 typically. Which we've done, right? So we're right there. We're really excited to launch. As you may also know, there is no FedRAMP ecommerce platform today in the market. If you guys haven't already tried to search for something like that, we are a sponsor away from getting that based on the existing work that we have with other agencies. So my question would be what are the requirements that you think would be ideal for a contract like this and would you consider FedRAMP sponsorship for a technology being used, and I guess a follow up directly to your question there is, is something like that considered in the total price in your sole source, when you're looking at what's fair and reasonable for past products which have not had an e-commerce platform that held such standards.

[Jaime Mijares] So I know we're taking a lot of this into consideration. Like I said, this is a market research format, so we are looking at all aspects of it, including the WBOS site and how we're currently, how it's currently in our requirements, and how that will work for us. So I do appreciate your information, given that; that way we could take it back to our contracting department and see you know is this the best path forward, how does this work - you know, what areas should we be looking at? And also is it a barrier to competition, if, if it's written in our requirements because I know like I heard the IDIQ might be a hindrance and so it's good to hear what the barriers are from you guys and also to meet companies that can potentially solve those issues, so thank you.

[Jackie Ferrari] One of the problems with the (we all know what the problems are with the IDIQ), but we would love it if you would take a look at ... It's your contract to lose. So for example, if you have a company or a group of companies who are performing well on their contract and you're putting something out to bid against, if you're on a 5-year term, you know the company that has that contract, it should really be their contract to lose, rather than somebody else's to gain, and if it's driven by price then they should have the opportunity to rebid saying, you know, listen, you're 30% higher than and if you want to keep this because the biggest issue is you

ramp up with employees, you ramp up with financing, you ramp up your company, you're solid and then you lose your contract and there's no that you know that is not as we try to move toward what industry does. That is not what industry does. You get you in industry. If you're clipping along and you're doing well and your score is high, your report card's great and you are serving your customer well, you own that contract, you continue to get that. So I we would love to have that kind of thought at least like have a think tank from your seat on what something like that looks for because that retains jobs. It puts money into the economy because you've got, you know, banks, then trust they'll lend you it just all around greases the economy instead of always living in this fear that, well, I can't ramp up because, you know, I've only got a year left on my contract. So I think it would just be a really good think tank opportunity for you.

[Tyler Kellogg] You're saying towards the completion of the contract to allow almost like a recompetete window for the contract holder, or would this be during the original solicitation?

[Jackie Ferrari] *inaudible*

[Tyler Kellogg] Like an option in the in the solicitation originally to allow that to happen, OK.

[Jackie Ferrari] *inaudible*

[Nancy Lewis] You know the rules of competition, you know, fall under the Federal Acquisition Regulation, so we don't have much of a say. There is the overhaul of the FAR, but that doesn't, it's not really changing the competition rules and it's to give you fair market opportunities.

[Jackie Ferrari] *inaudible* ... still putting it out there, but there should be some, I think somebody said that before. There should be some benefit to...

[Michael Stumo] Well, I think you're kind of talking about maintaining an industrial base and in this case of textiles as opposed to missiles. So Northrop Grumman and those all sort of have an ongoing relationship and it can be abused obviously, but you know an option, you know, a right of first refusal, to maintain a solid base over many years rather than the feast and famine, starve or uncertainty were as, as you say, Year 4 - you can't reinvest because you don't know if you're going to get something else. You know there's other considerations, but I, you know, your proposal makes sense to me.

[Nancy Lewis] And I think something we can consider is longer contracts then you know the typical is five years, but we do have longer term contracts and there would

be a good reason to make them longer in time.

[Andrew Nagle?] So it just dawned on me. I think we're talking about maybe there's two different things. So you got fulfilling going on, right? So the comment about fulfilling, he's not going to make anything, but I can't as a patch guy, like I can't bet on this. I don't want to bet on it, but I can't fulfill it. So whoever's making the shirt right, they're not going to fulfill it. So what happens with DLA is they're fulfilling, like they're fulfilling. So we're sending. That's why she can do shirts and pants. And we've been on a patch. We ship it to Industries for the Blind in Arizona, but we're not fulfilling, so I think you maybe need to look at two different things. One is, the computer system or the you know, that's why people like Workwear Outfitters win things, right? They've got the fulfillment and they log in, and you're logging in, and you're buying your uniform if you're a TSA agent. But the shorts coming from somebody else, the pants coming from somebody else, the shoes coming from somebody else. and then there's a warehouse with all the products in it. So when you bid that and that's where things get haywire. Like the fulfillment guy is going to win it and he's going to subcontract it. And then his subcontractors, there better be rules that he's got to buy Berry all the way down into the subcontracting. So it's almost like there's two different things going on there, fulfilling and then making, just like with the fabric guy, right? So he's not bidding on it. The shirt guy's bidding on it. So I think you got how to fulfill. And again, we appreciate you guys opening up to us in the thought process.

[Tyler Kellogg] I think it's part of it too. And as you can see, this is a clearly complex issue. We at the National Park Service, at the Department of Interior, there's a lot that we can't do internally. We do have a Chief Information Officer, but we probably can't order or offer a web-based ordering catalog system, but the contract vehicle and the comments we've received today will help drive the future contract vehicle as well and understanding the limitations from domestic manufacturers, kind of if that is a barrier to entry for a lot of folks if the way the contracts are currently structured, that's exactly what we're trying to poll today, so thank you for that too.

One of the items I did really want to hit on too was the number of items and I think it was mentioned ma'am in your comments. Was, you know, trying to line it out into pants, shirts, jackets. There's a lot in the in the current contract that we're trying to scope out as necessary. You know, I think it's about 1,000 items. There's, there's a lot

of ancillary items that we're looking into as well, it's lifeguard whistles, swim shorts, stuff like that that, you know, I think the overall intent right now is that when an American goes out to a National Park or a Fish and Wildlife Service refuge that the officer, the ranger, the law enforcement officer that they see is - their duty uniform is Made in America, to the extent possible, obviously, but you know it's down to the threads down to the patch that they're wearing to sort of your point. So that that's the intent. The question is like, how do we get there? How do we break up the complexity to the extent we can, because we do have a limiting contracting team? They're fantastic here, but we do have our own internal limitations because there's only so much we can break it down. So it's, you know, going back to our team here and seeing and analyzing if that's possible, to what level and extent we can break it down to. But yet the focus we have right now for the scope of the contract - is that an issue in terms of the number of items to source? And I think to your point, the contract vehicle itself speaks to that.

[Kevin Hickey] My name is Kevin Hickey, New Front Strategies Group, I've spent the entirety of my career in this space, and so it's interesting to watch. This conversation is around items, but you have 1,100 items in your current contract, you said, with multiple sizes, and you're operating a hybrid - I think a hybrid of a quartermaster and a prime vendor system, do you? Are you intending to shift away from that system, because with a limited contracting team, you really need to rely on industry to provide that outsourced service. Otherwise, it becomes immensely difficult for your users to, in the quartermaster allowance system, to say, hey, I need a replacement shirt in size medium in Yellowstone. That's a really complicated system. So is the structure of the contract going to shift to individual item or stay in this TLS or prime vendor contract? And then my second question, we're getting some pings from virtual attendees and they're asking how can they ask questions from the from the web cast? Is that possible?

[Tyler Kellogg] Sure, I'll answer that question and I'll hop over to the computer. I've got a mic over there set up where I can answer their questions, going through as well. But your question - it's complex, right? I don't remember the number of individual sites we shipped to roughly 30,000 employees of different sizes. You know you have maternity equipment, you have various male and female sizing, so it's very complex. I don't. Right now we're analyzing options, so I can't say exactly what we're

going to do because that's the point of the market research period here. But I don't believe the intent would be for Interior to, you know, conduct the logistics behind it. It'd be working with industry here to provide that service too.

[Michael Stumo] I'm going to have to take off, but thank you all.

[Tyler Kellogg] Yeah, I'll go ahead and pick up some of the questions from the computers, but if there's a question in the meantime, while I pull those up, please go ahead and ask.

[Sarah Welch] I have a question for the group - in our current paradigm where we are asking the contractor to do everything, and if there are people who can respond to this - Is it typical? Is it an industry standard to bundle the cost of all of the management pieces of this, the warehousing, the inventory, the sourcing, customization, all those things into the unit prices of the individual items? Or is it more typical to have some of those things broken out in and invoiceable separately, like program management or warehousing?

[Mike Saxon] Hi, Mike Saxon, Soie clothing. So we're a small manufacturer, to give you a sense, right? We make clothes, right? We assemble, do all that. So we get paid to make; we don't get paid to warehouse. We don't get paid for you know any of that, right? So the typical way that apparel manufacturers, especially a small manufacturer, would work is, you get a PO for the item, right? And maybe it's got a fully loaded cost includes packing and shipping, but that's it. Your three PL costs and your you know all of those other costs are typically beyond our scope. And that's why I want to sort of also support some of the comments you've heard here that the online ordering and the making probably need to be separate things. And there's ways to do that, like I don't think anyone here is like, oh, you can't do it. You know, there's ways to do that, but understand that your actual making industrial base doesn't have that capacity and probably doesn't want to build it.

Inaudible comment

[Jack Cravy?] Yeah, I was going to speak to that point. Ultimately it drives the cost up the more requirements that you're going to put into the contract and if you look historically, you probably won't see that because historically those platforms were poor experiences. So the government's asking for better experiences. So the price

has to go up because in these web ordering platforms, the audits, the controls, the security standards, the penetration testings, all have to occur just to store that data. So it doesn't; you can not order a single item, but I've got 7 people on biweekly calls with your CSOs, right? Like so it's an expensive thing to be able to manage, but it can be totally be done and it can be baked in; in our the contract that I was referencing last with DHS, we actually work with a supplier that or a distributor that worked with lots of manufacturers all under one, and it allowed for kind of like a two prong approach for us and them to be able to kind of, go for that contract and win it together. But it wasn't without a contracting officer who was, can I say the word, ballsy. OK. And said like, no, we want better. We're going to demand better. And in order to make better happen, we have to separate - he didn't separate it from the contract, but he said this must have a prime and a sub in which the sub is a technology provider. Because when you're talking about building an e-commerce web platform that's storing sensitive information, that is a totally different wheelhouse than her making you know material. So, just food for thought.

[Jeremy Turner] Jeremy Turner, Workwear Outfitters, short answer to your question, Sarah, is yes, that's typically how it works in the space we're in. We're an integrator. We're the incumbent, as most people know, on the current contract, we work with several of the manufacturers and folks within this room and one thing I want to point out is, we are all for US manufacturing and more US manufacturing, always have been. It has always, I say always, it's been a cost issue and we get the product manufactured where it's cost effective and where we can negotiate with you people right there, and you agree to the pricing. The main issue we see with going to a Berry situation is the volumes of some of the products that we were talking that they're on the program, the 1,000 or so items. There are several on there that are 100 units per year or less and they're not bought at one time, they're bought throughout the year through the allowances and allotment processes. If there are manufacturers here who are willing to make small runs, we would like to talk to you. That has always been a challenge of ours and a challenge of all the manufacturers, because it's hard to set up a line for 50 units a year or something. It's almost impossible in some cases, depending on what the product is, so, we are very open to having those conversations. And I want to thank you guys for putting this on today. It's very, very interesting, very good topic and again as the incumbent we would like to see more US made. It is going to mean more money and hopefully that means more

allowances for the folks out there to use for their uniforms and it's been a... The challenges again are mostly related to the willingness and ability capability to have the money to spend and some of those volumes. So just need to keep that in mind as we move forward. Thank you.

[Malek Lahmar] Hello, Malek Lahmar, of Salute Industries. So we make dress uniforms and I think this is a great, great question in the sense that a cut and sew operation does not have the expertise of an IT setup like he's mentioning. This is way outside of our scope, just like they won't have knowledge of, you know, the sewing part. So usually you have an expertise in the area of business. For you guys to have access to a wider array of manufacturers, splitting this between logistics and manufacturing would allow you to access a lot more manufacturers and companies willing to get into what you need and then have the stuff shipped to you know the logistics side that will handle shipping, payment, customer service, and maybe work with the IT section. I think this allows you, along with what Ms. Ferrari mentioned about contracting with factories that make shirts, pants, jackets - the equipment involved, the expertise and knowledge is not like, I know it looks like sewing, but you don't need the same equipment to make a suit and expertise than to make a shirt, so specialized manufacturers, one of the things that can be a problem is lower quantities along the year, but they'll have to be specialized in what they're doing. They can't do a one stop for everything.

[Ranae Call] Hi, my name is Ranae Call, I'm with Belleville Boot Manufacturing. We've got over 100 years of experience in providing footwear to the US military through DLA militaries across the globe. As a matter of fact, as well as a federal supplier, we're well versed in all that. We were having a conversation out earlier and I just wanted to bring up that when we're talking about those small runs or those various items that you have, helping you to understand what we have for COTS items commercially available is a big thing. Anything we can do to help you with that so that you're looking at what you need and also then looking at what's already out there, what we are already manufacturing and then to that what we call MCOTS. So we have this, but can you add this zipper or take that off or change the toe slightly? Those are much easier for us to do for a small run, because we're already buying all of the material to create that product and we're just going to do a slight modification. So anything we can do to help you know what's already out there and I imagine that's not just boots,

that's across the board. So that when you are looking at those small items like he's talking about, look to us to find out how close can we get you to that without having to go and completely make a brand new boot that only you are going to buy at the quantity of 300.

[David Costello] I'm David Costello of WPRC. I just want to address that the Department of Defense has the same issue with small quantities and buying lots of diverse items and they handle that through something called a simplified acquisition threshold. So you know below \$150,000, it actually just went up to \$200,000¹, maybe it goes back down again. But that allows some flexibility that actually I know the folks at DLA appreciate, because they have to buy lifeguard whistles too, in short. And you know, I just would encourage you, you know, take a look at that because you don't want that vast number of items in the handful of oddball things to dissuade you from going overall, Berry Amendment. So thank you.

[Jackie Ferrari] Yes, me again. Yeah, I we really think this should be Berry. I mean, I think everybody in the room could agree to that. I just want to share a story from the commercial space when it comes to capacities and volumes. And I think Kim Glass from NCTO said it really, really well. I can't say who it is just yet, but in the next two months there's a very large commercial company that is in the top 100 of the Fortune 500 who made the decision to go Berry Amendment and support what the President was talking about. So they came out and they're making 100% of their uniforms of a certain category in America, it's launching at the end of May and we put our first purchase orders for fabric and this is all Berry; first purchase orders for fabric in four weeks ago and by the end of July, we will deliver 376,000 pieces, 100% Berry and that is with the build of a new website. So exactly what you're asking, they wanted to have - a new website that manages the production they had that was not from America. Integrating it with America. So it'll probably end up being about 600 items. So I just wanted to share that story. We have the capacity to Kim's point, it's here, we move fast and we do small batch, but that's not all we want. So I'd love to help your Workwear Outfitters, but if I get the 100 pieces I want the 10,000 at the same time. So in addition to that, I do think that the cost and I learned a lot from this commercial order. The cost of the item they want to know what that item cost, and

¹ Note from Sarah Welch: the SAT is currently \$350,000. The Revolutionary FAR Overhaul (RFO) allows COs to use simplified procedures for acquisitions of commercial products and services up to \$9M.

the warehousing, the web build and warehousing and all of that, that's separate. So we absorbed the cost of the web build, but all of the warehousing and logistics and all that, that's a separate line item. So maybe there's a, you know, there's a separate bid for that that becomes an item for you, just like a patch.

[Tyler Kellogg] Yeah, I have one question online, from Mia from Kueen B. There are manufacturers entering the military uniforms program. One challenge they're seeing is sourcing Berry compliant fabrics in small quantities. Kind of what you're talking about right there, for PDM, sample and development, do you recommend for approved suppliers or strategies for new vendors to access compliant materials for initial submissions? Do you have any recommendations for approved supplies, suppliers, or strategies for new vendors to access compliant materials for initial submissions?

[Michelle Yates] Audience members can participate.

[unknown from WPRC] I mean, they're all here. I think; actually they're not all here. But yeah, we've got, you know, amongst our association, Kim's, we've got every part piece - finding fiber, boot, armor, helmet, you name it, 100% Berry compliant, your friends at DLA actually would probably be a good resource for anybody who is seeking a source, or if not reach out to one of the associations that operate in this space and we will find you an answer.

[unknown] Give the name of your association

[unknown] Warrior Protection and Readiness Coalition. Thank you and NCTO and AAFA has some knowledge of this, right, Kim?

[Tyler Kellogg] With that, see if you guys are comfortable with us putting the names of your companies out on the SAM.gov website too, just for items like this where it can encourage collaboration among the industry. That'd be fantastic. So thanks.

[Jaime Mijares] I know part of our issue is also warehousing - like we don't get bulk orders of like 50,000 items to save and then issue out, right? Most of our orders on the fulfillment side and I can't remember who said it, but it was said perfectly, is you know we order items and then it ships out directly to you know the rangers or the parks? Because we just currently we're not warehousing most of it, a couple of the bureaus might be, but is that a barrier for industry out there; like are you guys able to ship them out separately or instead of just bulk orders to one warehouse to hold and then ship out?

[unknown, maybe Jessica Sweet-Proulx] I know my segment is very small compared to everyone else here, but I know for us, for us, we wouldn't have a problem doing drop shipments. It comes down to the contracting quantities. Oftentimes IDIQs are like, you know, we'll promise to order 30 pieces over the course of five years, but we could order 10 million and it's like, well, what are we supposed to do with that? Because we can't prepare for anything; but drop shipping's fine, if you can get within a reasonable percentage of what you'll actually plan on ordering. Because then again that just becomes part of the growth expense that comes part of, you know, just regular everyday logistics. But we can't plan to drop ship a million pieces if you're only promising to order realistically, you know, 100,000; like, that's a huge window of differentiation there.

[Ranae Call] ... you know, I don't think that Workwear Outfitters, as he said before. He's fine if it's all US made, if it's all Berry Amendment, he's going to go source that and he's going to come to us and get it. So I don't know that it's a hindrance to do it that way. What's important to us, is that when he's going and sourcing those, he's required to come to the US manufacturers for that product because in fairness to him, if he's not required to and he's bidding at a price where he's got to meet a price point or beat the other guy. And if he comes and only brings our product and somebody else comes with that patch that's made with thread from China in a garage in New Jersey, you know, he's got to compete at price level. So it's really about that requirement for where it's made, I think is what hits the button.

[Tyler Kellogg] Just a comment on it too, ma'am, to your point, like for the enforcement, I'd recommend looking into the President's EO, think it was two weeks ago that he put it out. But I did have some reach out for a very similar issue as well, but please like connect with me on that issue. Moving forward, I can reach out to the Made In America Office as well, but that is a major focus of the administration right now, would be the enforcement of American-made, as applicable within regulation.

[Ashley McCullen] Yeah, it's Ashley McCullen from Milliken. And I think one of the things is this whole contract there are a lot of barriers to entry on the main contract. There are only a few players in this room and outside of this room they're going to be able to satisfy that, and I think that's where you keep hearing a lot of these comments about if it is Berry, it actually allows the whole room to participate in that contract. And so, I mean, the barriers to entry are huge, if you're thinking about that

single contract; I mean she already mentioned it, it's a lot that happens that none of us can do on our own. So I think it really keeps going back to that Berry and those consistent numbers and being able to give here's a much smaller range that you're going to do. So when you know whoever does win the contract is able to give out those subcontracts. That's really where the investment pieces and how do we manage our plants, how do we hire? That's the really important piece, is do those subcontractors have that five year plan? Not just whoever gets the single contract.

[inaudible]

[JP Rammo] JP Rammo, with Milliken. Just want to add a little bit to what Ashley was saying and hopefully pull in some other context here. I think the key message here is the Berry requirement is crucial. The way that Department of Interior contracts and solicitations happen right now, they do not require Berry. If you make them Berry, then everyone in this room can participate. One thing that I'll just mention about Milliken is we're, I dare to say, one of the largest, if not the largest, American fabric manufacturers - we're the fabric piece and we rely on our cut and sew partners here to get you the final product. And then there is the conversation absolutely about the trimmings and the finishings and the patches and the enforcement of that. I think you know when we think about the business that we're the most proud of is clothing American government employees, whether it's our war fighters, whether it's our National Park Service rangers, we're incredibly proud of it. But maybe the elephant in the room that you know, we should make very clear is that it's a very small, Milliken's, a very small portion of Milliken's larger fabric production and that's a benefit to the government. That's important because of our commercial and business, because of our diversification, we're able to ride out these roller coasters of government demand. But we are not a prime contract holder, and so you know where we might be able to ride some of those demands, our partners can't, and so what we want to do is secure that entire supply chain so that you have what you need and so that it also meets your warehousing needs because your warehousing, you know, capabilities are very different than DLA and others that we work with and I think that's another big elephant in the room. We need to talk about warehousing and inventory because that's hard to manage even if Milliken can manage that better than maybe others in the supply chain, this is still an incredible burden to a private company. And so just wanted to kind of flag that it all comes back to that very requirement and you know just the diversification of our business allows us to ride this out. But not everyone in this room has that luxury. And but we can't do it without

them either, we can't stand alone, so that's the That's the kind of conundrum we've got to solve here.

[Michelle Yates] So I'm going to add, you know, like we said, this is market research, but we also look at this and together, I think this whole panel here, this is an opportunity for us to meet what we need, and also an opportunity for you to help find some partnerships and some communication within your organizations to where you can help us meet the need and the Executive Order. To us, this is an opportunity for you guys to get together and have conversations because I don't know how often you guys meet. But this to us is, this is another reason why we felt this vendor fair is very important for partnerships - to see if there's ways to help DOI meet this uniform program is by having the industry, like we said, in this room and can find out solutions because as we've said, we've done some subcontracting to meet some of these demands and we do have opportunities where it is small orders or stuff like that, but that's why we really this is also an opportunity for us for you guys to give us feedback, but an opportunity for you guys to work together and say, hey, we can do this and so that this is kind of I think a big thing that we were looking for, is for you guys to come to us.

[Tyler Kellogg] I think coordination, as you said too, is perfect for us. I mean, this is the first industry day I think we posted in 20 years. Made in America office. If you don't reach out to them on the weekly basis, they've been entirely supportive here and have been driving us pretty hard. Speed being one of them, too, the president, moves at a very fast pace, as you guys can probably see. So that drives us to move at a very fast pace too, but it's making sure that we take the time for market research to ensure we understand your constraints. If it's the line items to the number broken down. If it's one larger contract versus smaller contracts, that's kind of the information we needed to know. But we are also balancing moving rapidly with the administration's intent, but also making sure the intent is to support domestic manufacturing. So if we were to weigh, you know, what the overall goal I would say would be is to support domestic manufacturing. Taking the time to do the market research to understand which contract vehicle is going to maximize that and execute with that. We're not Berry compliant, the Made in America Office can tell you that. DLA, who's here? Leighann [Mazoki]'s in the back there, I recommend you talk to her, but they are Berry compliant. We are not, but there are tools that we're, you know, analyzing right now with the FAR overhaul that could be used to help increase

domestic compliance. There's tools to write in the contract itself that we're analyzing as well; I can't speak to them, I'm not a procurement expert too, but we're analyzing every option that's available to us, but you know, sadly we're not Berry compliant. We don't have the same restrictions, but there are tools that we can use that focus on domestic industry. One of those is time. You know, it's the time, like I said, we're moving as fast as possible, but also it's making sure we take the time to do it right, which is why we're here today.

[unknown, maybe Jack Cravy] I was going to add on the on the fulfillment piece and the warehousing. Obviously you'd want that driven by agency demand of what they're going to need very soon, almost as if it's baked into your product matrix, is what I would recommend. Something that you're going to need between two to three days, like an Amazon style type of experience on delivery. We work with strategic national stockpile and HHS for other needs, but I'm sure the Department of Interior doesn't have quite as, but it may have some, and so that should just be considered when you bake that in, but also to be a stickler on the IT side, OK, like all that CUI and PII information is also going into whatever technology is being managed by the warehouse itself. We also do that for anyone in here who is looking for secure warehouse management software, but appreciative of this industry day. But I think something like that has to also be considered too. If you're going to warehouse said product, then all that information is going on a label and that's being printed and that's being held by somebody and there's standards for that, today, that didn't used to be.

[Tyler Kellogg] It's hard to understand. See, I've not come from the industry, by the way too. I didn't really know what went into a uniform like Charles here is wearing. It's like I thought I thought we were just issued a uniform with everything there. I mean, I had to buy my medals too, for my ribbon rack, too. I was like, didn't really understand the complex process too, but now being here for the past six months, understanding it all too, it's very complex and you know moving from thread to patches to where it gets all cut and sewn together. It's a very complex process too, so thank you.

[unknown, maybe Jessica Sweet-Proulx] I'd love to invite you to our factory and anybody else who wants to come. We call ourselves third world manufacturing

because it's dying skills, you know, tool makers and dye makers and press operators. These are these are skills that are dying. And so having your assistance on staying Berry compliant and gearing everything towards American-made is crucial, otherwise, we will lose those skills. We will lose them. So thank you for that. An example I was going to give before - we actually are involved with the NPS name badges. We help produce those, we are not the prime on them because the prime on them can handle the warehousing and the quick returns if somebody scratches it and they need a new one and we could do that no problem, but the time frame on it and the lack of allowances for like the back and forth like hey, logistically this doesn't make sense. I think in the past the government on a whole, you know that we've dealt with have kind of held the mentality of well, if you can't, someone else can and it's like, sure, sure. But a lot of those companies are ordering their stuff from China, so they have the money to put into the logistics because they're not worried about the expense of the material and the products and the labor it takes to make it. An example of that is I know you guys listed a bunch of other agencies that were hopefully going to be adding on to this effort. The Secret Service is one of the largest purchasers of flag lapel pins, which is, you know, you may or may not know that we lost a bit a few years ago for 1/2 a cent to a Chinese manufacturer, 1/2 a cent. And it was, you know, millions of lapel pins for a company that is making them entirely by hand in America. That's not a small fee and that's not a small contract, you know, dollar wise it might be compared to what these textile companies are doing, but for a company that is pressing and epoxying and electroplating here, everything by hand - 1/2 a penny. So that's why I kind of bring it back to what do you guys consider reasonable when you're comparing if the Berry Amendment should be relevant? 1/2 a cent should be relevant for 100% made in the USA.

[Sarah Welch] And I have a related comment. It's not directly a response to that, but Mike earlier mentioned the proclivity of contracting officers to use lowest price technically acceptable as the evaluation strategy. And I would say that in the Department, we don't necessarily rely on that, certainly not as our first choice, I would say. Most things are done as a best value and we tailor the evaluation factors for each procurement based on the goals and the market research and everything about that procurement. So we're typically not doing lowest price or lowest price technically acceptable.

[Michelle Yates] And like Sarah said, we try to, you know, we try to go for. Oh, sorry, we like Sarah said... We really try to; it's very rare occasions that we do that [LPTA]. we're more into the best value. It's, you know, I'm sorry about the half cent.

[unknown, maybe Jessica Sweet-Proulx] So yeah, definitely sorry.

[Nancy Lewis] The rules have changed, also, there you have to write a justification if you want to go lowest price technically acceptable at this point. So we are looking for best value, but those things happen. But we try, you know. Maybe, I will just say this and I know all of us have said it - this is very helpful to get your ideas and what the challenges are and really helpful for when we move forward to figure out you know, what processes we're going to use. So thank you.

[Tyler Kellogg] Just that as well, Gunnar, do you want to raise your hand in the back for the Made in America office, he's a fantastic point of contact. He's been a driving force behind, so I recommend that you talk to him afterwards regarding Secret Service as well, and any other issues you have; but there are other agencies in the room here. I believe we have the USDA here in the back as well. But there's other agencies here who are looking to follow our process. As Michael said, we are the tip of the spear, learning the process and building it out. But other agencies are going to be following our lead, either you know, working through DLA, pursuing their own procurement vehicle. But the intent right now is for all federal agencies to kind of follow the lead we're setting here. I mean, DOW is in the lead right now because they have the Berry amendment. It's not really fair to say that, but the intent is, this is every agency doing this, and Gunnar, you can back me up on that, right? OK, thumbs up; but the intent is for everyone to do this for across the agencies. This is just us leading the effort and we're going to share our lessons learned with them through the Made in America Office, also through a working group set up by the President's Management council. So this is really the first test case and that's why I also want to make sure we do it right. But like I said, integrate with the other agencies that are here. I cannot say enough to integrate with the Made in America Office as well. No problem is too small if it supports American workers and American manufacturing.

[Katrina Gendel] Katrina Gendell with Brookwood companies. Within the Department of Interior, we're talking specifically about uniforms, but a lot of the manufacturers in here make more than uniforms. You know, some of the cut and sews do packs and

bags and tents and sleeping bags and stuff. So is there an effort on your team to look at those types of contracts to incorporate the Berry amendment in those as well?

[Michelle Yates] Well, we know currently on the uniform contract, there are hats there. We do have hats. I don't know about tents and stuff, but we do have outerwear hats. If you go to the Park Service and they have different forms of hats, a lot of them do that. They have outerwear like coats, jackets. Like you said, we - like Charles, our model - he has badges and things like that. I think the Uniform Committee does add things every year, sometimes or take away, Charles, right? And so, but yeah, there are other products that we do use there.

[Tyler Kellogg] Luckily aren't any heavy equipment manufacturers in the room; if there are, raise your hand. But no, we're looking across Interior procurement. So we had a data call out that was basically looking at what is acquired from foreign sources, and going through that understanding how they have received waivers for that. And each of those waivers now for foreign procurement has to be approved by our senior procurement individual through our policy management and budget office too. But no, we're looking literally across the board, every single line item; we are pulling that data, and we're going through it finding out where the issues are. You know, if there's a permit [waiver] there, why is there a permit there? I think our biggest source right now of procurement is IT system software and hardware as well. We don't make computers as much as we should in America. But no, we're going across the board.

We should probably cover... We had a list of questions, I think we put out on SAM.gov as well, just to make sure that we're, you know, receiving the information we need to for our contract vehicle too. So for the team here, is there any additional information, going through our list of questions, that we're currently lacking, you know for this procurement vehicle right now?

I think sizing, and this probably isn't applicable to everybody in the room too, but you know for sizing for unisex sizing, you know is there currently a traditional industry standard that you guys have or practice; one that's used right now? Or what's the constraints in terms of sizing like, is there a certain limit we should look into for sizing in terms of individual customization? I know maternity uniforms for the DOW that was an issue I think a decade ago, too, was making sure we had the correct size uniforms for everybody who is a war fighter there. But for the, I would say the sizing issues right now, there's probably hundreds of different types of sizes

for, between male and female and unisex. But you know the number of items there is probably a limitation or constraint to procurement. So if anybody could speak to that, that'd be fantastic

[unknown] I can say. Anyway, you know when you're talking male and female. And I'd love to see everything in a male and a female size, but not from a manufacturing standpoint, I don't want to see that because of the volume. So if your volume for a female item is quite small from a footwear standpoint, obviously not a maternity uniform, but from a footwear standpoint, DLA especially, they tend to order a unisex or we call it a male size and then females are instructed to order 2 sizes down, and that pushes that volume together and makes it greater. So where you can do that, where it makes sense, where it still serves the end customer; we don't want to not serve that end customer that is in uniform, but where you can, it certainly helps us.

[Jackie Ferrari] We have to do all the sizes. I mean, we don't, you know, women don't want to wear men's clothing - it looks terrible, it feels terrible, so I think as an industry we just have to do it. I think where we have the two way conversation, if it's an extra small like I find in the commercial space, very few like in a manly kind of business, where maybe there's 5% of the workforce is female and there's an extra small. I mean the factories that I represent, they really deal with that in their sample room; it's a sample order. It's so you kind of have to get creative, because even when you're looking at pricing, you want the median of the sizes, you want the regular size scale to reflect your pricing, because that's all based on the yield of the fabric. So you want that to reflect your pricing and these one-offs, I mean sometimes companies can spend 2 weeks discussing something that's less than 1% of the total buy. So I think you have to go into it with eyes wide open and say here's the majority of what we're doing, and then here's these one-offs, and then make it a dual conversation - How do we manage this, OK? I need extra smalls, but I only need 80. Well, I need you to do 360 and you'll just have to warehouse those and use, you know, so I'm saying like, just get creative and be open to looking at things differently.

[Tyler Kellogg] Thanks, Jackie. Just from the contracting team side, any additional questions that you have, too?

[Jaime Mijares] I just have one. So I heard maybe breaking up the contract like in categories, right? Like pants and shirts, something like that. We can look into, are

colors an issue as well, like for instance, US Fish and Wildlife uses a specific color brown, and you know, I think BOR uses a blue; so are colors an issue? and would you also consider, like would it be smart to consider breaking it up in any other categorical ways in order to get more competition? Like, further, I guess.

[maybe Charles Cuvelier, NPS] We call it Ranger Green, but the Pantone colors is of red, green and blue, I can't remember off the top of my head; there are three numbers. I can tell you that.

[Jeremy Turner] On the color situation, brown has been a challenge. If you speak to some of the fabric mills in the room, they will tell you that it comes down to minimums and volumes and how many yards have to be run of a certain fabric. Combining colors would be helpful; I hope Wade doesn't come and slap me. But that is that is a challenge and again it's a numbers game. I want to go back to some of the comments about the female and the unisex. It really comes down to where the pattern is being made and the consistencies of those patterns for the female sizing and for the unisex sizing; you do get variations from factory to factory. DLA I think uses the MILSpec and that should take care of most of that issue if you go that route. Now, I'm not advocating necessarily MILSpecs for these uniforms because MILSpecs are a little bit thicker than the other specs. But that is one of the challenges that you'll see from factory to factory. You may see variation in sizing and I won't address the question about more competition.

[Tyler Kellogg] With that too, Sir, thank you for the specifications, like for domestic production, what are the items that right now would probably favor foreign procurement versus domestic? Do we have a thicker fabric that's typically more sourced domestically, right now, that our industries produce, that's in our requirements, right, that are inadvertently favoring foreign procurement? You know, does a southeast country have thinner fabrics that are able to make it cheaper than our domestic manufacturing industries, or is there anything there that folks could speak to?

[unknown] So volume is key. I mean I think that's one of the biggest things and going back to the color comment too, for the fabric producers, if we're making five colors, it's going to be much more cost efficient for, you know, one person to make

those five colors versus trying to split those five colors up amongst everybody, so I think volume is the biggest in forecasting. If it's really tiny volume, that's really where the issue is in the domestic manufacturing. And then I think one more point kind of you talked about a little bit about the sizes. But I would say in the tech packs, the actual fabric specifications, I think a lot more information needs to be provided there, so on some of these garments, if we're really looking at that continuity, what's called out in the spec - I could give you 50 fabrics that technically meet that, and that's not what you want, you know, going forward. So I think on those tech packs, some of them call out, I think we just need to have a very defined what the fabric is on those with some spec requirements.

[Tyler Kellogg] With that too, that's like the exact information we're looking for. Like is there a specific fabric composition that is more domestically produced versus foreign produced that you could speak to?

[unknown] I mean, I think you can get really whatever most of what's in that contract. I mean, you're 65/35 poly-cotton, 100% cotton, 100% polyester. I mean, most of the contract [items] appears to be woven, some more of it is knits, but some of them call out really like performance fabric, and it really needs to be more, you know a 65/35 poly-cotton at this weight with this, if it's stretched, what percent stretch? You know, really a specification, so that if you go out and whoever does win the contract goes to the fabric mills and says I need this. Then those mills are all giving them the same thing, where it's not you've got four different fabrics because they all read that differently.

[Tyler Kellogg] And for those fabric mills of that composition, I mean it would be, is there a challenge in the industry like for the actual creation of the fabrics on the content itself? Like for polyester.

[unknown] No, really, there's, you know, I work for [a spinning mill] and not knits. But we could pretty much weave any fabrics that you could procure overseas. Granted, there may be some restrictions on the type of weave, like if you're getting into fancy jacquards, but what I'm seeing over here, all of that can be done domestically at many of the - Milliken, Greenwood - many of the mills. My experience with regards to minimums and dye lots: Most finishers want 10,000 yards for a run once the fabric, once the color is established, and you come in and if because anything less than that is incurring, it's a whole lot more cost to shut down the line to change the colorations. So 10,000 yards, you have what, 4 yards in a garment? You know, you do the math on how many garments that would be. That's tops and bottoms, so, that's,

you know, that's basically my experience with the dye lot runs.

[Sarah Welch] I have a follow up question. So is there one industry standard that has all those specs for like stretch and thread count and everything? Or are there a variety of those specs out there?

[unknown] Yes, I think it really depends on what garment it is. And so if you go look at like a pant versus a shirt, the dress uniform versus a more casual, like you really need to look at the actual fabric that's in there today. And so really, there may be some testing, but we can kind of talk about like, here the seven items that you would want to make sure you have so that you have continuity between the uniforms that you have out there today and what you're sourcing in two years.

[Michelle Yates] Yeah, I think that's one of the things is we want to make sure you know we do, I mean, we want to make sure when Charles stands next to another uniform employee, they look consistently the same. I think that's the biggest, one of the biggest things, that we want to make sure that we, you know, that the consistent color is that's been one of the things the uniform. So thank you.

[Ranae Call] I was just going to speak for a minute to kind of constraints, and I'm going to speak towards the DHS contract for a moment in because I've been working with Workwear Outfitters and others that are putting bids together for it, and sometimes there's requirements that just can't be met and I'm going to give you an example. PFAS is a big conversation right now and see lots of nodding of heads. And I've had the folks from Workwear Outfitters and we've had multiple conversations because DHS is looking for a boot. It needs to be Berry Amendment compliant. It also needs to be flight certified. Well, actually, I'm sorry it has to be TAA compliant. This particular has to be TAA, not Berry. But it has to be flight certified and whoever wrote the contract didn't understand was how to get flight certified. That comes from the United States Air Force and the United States Air Force, the body that does that flight certification will only certify I'm sorry, certify a Berry Amendment boot. Which is great. However, at this time, exactly, there it is, there is no such animal as a Berry Amendment compliant flight certified boot and so no matter how many times the folks that are bidding on it come and ask me for it, I can tell them I have a flight certified boot or I have a TAA boot that meets the PFAS - no PFAS intentionally added - which is the language we like to use these days. So there's also that needing to know what's out there and that the industry is working to get that. But it comes down to that waterproof lining in that flight certified boot and then even if we've got

the fabric, you've got to get through the certification process to get there. So making sure that when you're writing those requirements you haven't, in that case, you've not, you've just simply made it so it can't be produced - it's not there. You can't fill that and then when they go back and ask, the contracting officer, can we, you know, do one or the other, no, it still has to be both. Well, both doesn't exist.

[Andrew Nagle?] Real quick. You asked a question. Can you write the specs to prevent foreign components? And the answer is no. They can copy anything we can do in our world. So no, it's got to get back to Berry and when you keep hearing that, we keep saying Berry, Berry, Berry, what you can do is partner with DLA. So the new heritage green jacket, you know, is it the same construction? So that's a big fabric issue right now for the army in the new dress uniform, so the heritage green fabric, you know, and I'm not a fabric maker, but you know, we needed to make the chevrons and then can you look at other departments and find commonality? And don't invent your own fabric when it's being made maybe for DLA and maybe in another shade, you know, but look for commonality with DLA in those components; I believe would help you out a lot.

[John Colleran?] Sorry, a quick point very specific to fabric labels. We're talking about the label that says what size it is, like size, small size medium, how to wear it, how to care for it. All the danger warnings as well. Actually you can write a specification and end up with an only American fabric, and that's actually what our friends at DLA have done. And so again, we have a fabric that is very specific for their requirements from a performance standpoint, and I don't know before a knockoff, but if you write, well, then let's talk about enforcement as well. But again, if you write it a different way, you're going to end up with a fabric label that is only made overseas, or one that you think is Made in America, but the knockoffs, like, you know, our friends with Tyvek, you have to have a very specific fabric made the labels and for the printing. There's one for Tyvek, there are several knockoffs from overseas already, so again, in our world actually you can pick and choose something that's only American, and I'd love to talk to you about that after.

[Nancy Lewis] For now that that's being done and maybe it's at DHS that does testing for fabrics that are... OK, because I didn't, I think that their enforcement measures are coming, but I think they are testing and that I think would certainly be part of the contract language, that there would be testing.

[Michelle Yates] Can I ask a question? I hear you guys, you know, you're saying enforcement. How do you in the industry enforce that you are doing Buy American? I'm just curious, how do you... is there an enforcement that you do within? OK, OK.

[unknown] A couple years ago we had somebody putting forward marking material saying that their fabric was meeting all of the performance requirements of what we call a Type 6, there are like 19 performance requirements and we kind of knew that they weren't. We asked the Defense Department to send a letter, you know something on government letterhead? It just sends a pretty clear message that somebody's paying attention. So it doesn't have to be anything too big. It can be as simple as, you know, having an opportunity for like a small business office or ombudsman for us to reach out to and say hey, you know something is fishy, feels like it's happening right now, can you just send a letter to double-check on that? And similarly, I would expect that if you ever sent me a letter, I'd be able to demonstrate my supply chain and to be able to demonstrate that all my components are.

[Michelle Yates] That would be a question I think we would want to go, let's just say to make sure.

[Gunnar Enlow] I think then come talk to us at the Made In America Office [inaudible].

[Nancy Lewis] And it would, it would also be the responsibility of the contracting officer, that if we were made aware of the fact that there's some kind of fraud or something going on to actually investigate that.

[Michelle Yates] And we would come back to you and ask you, hey, you know, is this made American can you show us how? And we would come back, I mean that's why I was just curious. You talked about enforcement. How do you guys as a company, do your enforcement to make sure that they are compliant?

[David Costello] So, David Costello, WPRC I can address that and our friends at DLA will give you a concrete examples. But in the Department of War, Berry Amendment is self-certifying and the way that it gets out that you're not complying is usually one of your competitors raises it. And there's been examples of people who make the commodities in this room, there was an example in combat boots where someone was importing combat boots during a time of war from China, relabeling them as US made and those people went to jail. So that's a real thing. DLA had an issue with zippers and fasteners a little while ago and turned out they were being made from China. And so, you know, a Berry Amendment product, if you sew a Chinese made zipper into his uniform, that makes the entire uniform non Berry compliant. So, but

there is no Berry Amendment police; sometimes we wish we had them. Here, let me give you the microphone. Is that OK?

[Ranae Call] I was actually involved in this a little bit. I had, I'm in inside sales at Belleville and I had a dealer in Kansas City and he said, hey, Ranae, funniest thing and I'm not going to name names of who, but he says I got these boots and the label is peeling off the made in USA label is peeling off and underneath, guess what it says. And I said, could you send me a pair of those? I'll send you a prepaid shipping label. Well, if you'll send me a pair of those boots, he goes, I'll get them to you. Ship them to me. I gave them to my boss up the chain and I'm pretty sure it found its way to DLA to somebody in the contracting office and then, you know, like David said, somebody ended up in jail. But we are very self-policing in that if we find out something, it's in our interest to get that information to you.

[Jaime Mijares] I just have one more question. So I've heard a lot about pricing today and I've heard a gauge of, you know, that if you're willing to pay for it or that it's going to cost more. Is domestically sourced items really that much more? Is it more expensive or is it a misconception? *[group audience response saying "more expensive"]* And by more expensive, are we talking like and you know, just 4% or 400%, you know like is it, more expensive or is it like...?

[Charles Cuvelier?] So Zoe said it's at least 25% who would agree with that? Just raise your hand. It's at least 25%. That's low. OK, who says it's 40% or more? So somewhere between 25 and 40, there you go.

[unknown] In North Carolina, so we pay \$21.00 an hour; it's \$3.00 now in China.

[inaudible]

[unknown] You know the table up there? Is it more expensive? Yes. And I think most of the room would agree. While labor is significantly more, labor's not everything in, so that 25% to 40%, in some cases it's closer to parity, in some places it may be 100% and maybe 50% more, right, but you're going to find a range, really, for any item you're looking at on those thousand, so a number of them could be close, some maybe 50% more, but that 25%.... *[inaudible]*

[unknown] But there there's a wide, there's a lot and we're always happy to provide general ballpark estimates too, so that those numbers are more concrete for you. If you're guessing, if it's a 10% increase or a 5%. We're happy to go through that exercise and also, maybe this goes without saying, but it's probably just important to say this isn't a, you know, a crazy margin grab for this room. You know, we want the

volume, we want to be making these, so we're all desperate for the volume, and so we're ready to, you know, kind of play ball here and not trying to, also legally not allowed to have, you know, a certain margin. So just want you to know we want to work with you on that.

[Ramie Lynch] Hello everyone, my name is Ramie Lynch, I'm with the National Park Service. I'm currently modeling the work uniform. I have a question for the group here today and it mainly deals with shared uniform items. So I guess I'm speaking for the government, right? So for the government, when we have the exact same shirt at the National Park Service, Bureau of Land Management, US Fish and Wildlife Service, BSEE, all of us, if we're all wearing the exact same shirt, right? Same fabric, same everything, right, the only difference being color and customization. In other words, I may have a Park Service arrowhead and they may have whatever emblem for their organization, would you define that as a shared item? As the government, I would think hey, basically that's the same shirt, right? I want to know from you would you define that as shared or would you define that more as, no, that's not shared, even though the pattern, the materials, everything is the same, the color and the customization makes it a separate item. So that would be my question to you.

[inaudible]

[Ramie Lynch] Okay, it's not shared. All right, I have a follow up to that. I'm sorry, I'm a program manager. I get, you know, you'll meet me over there at 1:00 at the Park Service table. So one of my counterparts is with U.S. Army Corps of Engineers and our uniform is basically the same, right? Same color, same everything, the only difference is in customization. Mine will have a Park Service patch, whereas his uniform would have the US Army Corps of Engineers patch, would you define that as a shared item? Yes, OK, great. All right. Thank you.

[Tyler Kellogg] So we've got about probably about 5 minutes left to I do have one question from our online team's town hall. It's regarding inflation and making sure that's possibly priced into the contract, let's see if I can read it here. "Inflation, regardless of its causes, including government spending, creates a real and often unpredictable cost. Pressures at labor, materials and freight. When that risk is placed entirely on the contractor, it can force unsustainable pricing decisions and in some cases lead to losses that small American manufacturers cannot absorb. Would you consider incorporating a standardized inflation adjustment provision into the future

contract to better balance risk, encourage more accurate bidding, and support a stable domestic supplier?" And that's more to your point, too, about COVID as well. I said that the vehicle like it's not yet created, too, and we're open to suggestions for what's going to make American companies compete and encourage domestic production? So I'd say as we write the vehicle, just soliciting input like that to what's going to make it more competitive too. But I mean, I'd ask the group right now if that would be helpful and encourage competition. I would say probably the odds are in the room for that. So thank you. And that was from Dan Greer at Marla White.

[Jaime Mijares] And that is one reason why we do generally have five year contracts, is because we understand the market prices change, right? We understand that within a five year period of performance like we could go through something like COVID where you know pricings are, pricing is going to change. So that's why we do generally award the five year contracts, as well as because of the fact that like pricing changes. And within the, our current IDIQ, we have option periods where you know, I mean you guys can account for escalation or things like that. *[Sarah Welch reminds her we've used a five-year ordering period with five pricing periods.]* So pricing periods, there we go. They're called pricing periods, but that way you know, there's that potential for escalation there.

[Charles Cuvelier?] Can you clarify? Once you establish a pricing period, you can't adjust it again, right, whereas the question was related to inflation adjustment, which could occur at any point in time when it happens. OK, thanks for the clarification.

[Jaime Mijares] And even under the uniform contract, like if something goes away, like sometimes the sources go away or the material goes away, and we need to resource an item or replace an item or add an item. At that time, then you know, we do look at cost for how to replace that item. And so there are potentials within a contract to relook at that. But that's currently, and I'm not sure how it's going to move forward.

[Tyler Kellogg] I'll allow for one last question too, as we wrap it up here a little bit of over time, but I know you guys have all traveled a long way here, so thank you for that too, but we have time for one last question here, so, or comment.

[unknown] Someone was having trouble getting into the online question they'd asked. I think I know the answer, but is there any need for flame resistant uniforms, fabrics, textiles within the Department of Interior in this contract?

[Tyler Kellogg] Yep. We as we're changing up the new wildland fire service, they're not represented on the initial deck today, but as we stand up the Wildland Fire service, absolutely.

[unknown] Thank you.

[Tyler Kellogg] Sorry, and BSEE too.

[Tyler Kellogg] All right. Well, I had a speech here prepared, but at the same time it's all right. I do know you guys have come a long way to get here too. I'm sorry that the rain happened today to you, as I said the cherry blossoms are fantastic, so I know how much work that you guys put into it and from my perspective here, like I said, I wore a uniform for, actually, I think 14 years; I was a cadet for four years as well, and prior service before that, so it's been a long time wearing a uniform. I'm kind of a hypocrite. My suit here is Canadian, and my tie is Italian, so I promise to you guys next time you see me, I will be wearing a full American-made outfit in line with this mission I sent to you. But it is difficult, right?, to find it too. I understand that, but as a person myself individually, I'll work to achieve the administration's objectives, but just to show you how serious we are there, putting this event on has been fantastic and sitting in front of all of you hearing all about your individual companies, your lines of work has been phenomenal. Hopefully it's the same for the contracting team here. There's a lot more information we need, you know, this has been fantastic. I'll provide the transcription and the recording on the SAM.gov site for everyone to go back to and look through, but I can already see that we're going to need a lot more information, but we are moving fast so if you see the SAM.gov postings, if you get reached out to from the office of the Secretary here or any of the contracting team here, please respond because that's the information we're looking to incorporate to encourage domestic manufacturing. And as I said before too, we're looking at creative ways to make sure that we apply; our contract is applicable to all laws at the same time. What more can we do? The emphasis is on the from the White House. You know this is 1/3 of the President's management agenda is Buy American to increase American manufacturing, so our supply chains are available to potentially support national security matters too. So there are a lot of 2nd and 3rd order effects across, they're not specifically applicable to Interior, and as I said this, we're the tip of the spear. You're going to see other agencies joining the effort as well. If it's through DLA, if it's through their own contract vehicle, be on the lookout for that. Be on the lookout for additional Industry Day events hosted by the other agencies. And who

knows, for the Made In America Office, too, they want to get a round table or something like that together because I'm not sure if all the comments are getting through to hear all of your concerns. But please be responsive.

I encourage you to go around the tables here to see what our uniforms look like. It's the first time I've seen a couple of them from BSEE, so fantastic to have you guys out here as well. Go through, take, take the time, look at the uniforms, look at the materials, think of creative solutions on your end, because we have our team working here, but we're just a small team. But again, thank you so much to everyone who's here. I'll be available afterwards and the team will be available afterwards to meet individually, but we do want to set up one-on-one sessions in the next week or two weeks where we can meet with you virtually with the whole team here; we can understand any additional needs or specific issues that could be inadvertently, you know, encouraging foreign procurement. So I look forward to that and I'll give you guys my card at the end of this too. Please feel free to reach out. I'll be as responsive as I can, but the team here also can reach out too, so thank you all here. We have refreshments, have you seen, in the room out there. But look forward to talking to you. Thank you so much. Thank you.

● stopped transcription

Participating entities (in person and virtual):

5.11

Amer Sports Winter & Outdoor Company (Salomon Footwear)

American Apparel, Inc.

American Fashion Network

Anatar, Inc.

Aspetto Inc

Avocet Ventures, LLC d.b.a C.N. Clark Company

Belleville Shoe Mfg. Co

Brookwood Companies

Carhartt

Cart Government Solutions

Cascade Designs, Inc.

Conrad Industries, Inc

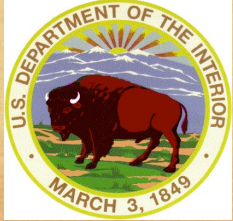
Darlington Fabrics

Defense Logistics Agency – Troop Support

Fechheimer Brothers Company

Federal Prison industries (FPI) dba Unicor

Galls, LLC
Greenwood Mills
Marlow White Uniforms
Milliken & Co.
MMI Textiles, Inc
MUSTANG SURVIVAL MFG, INC
National Council of Textile Organizations
National Industries for the Blind (NIB)
New York Embroidery Studio
NGONGE LLC
Noble Supply & Logistics
Office of Textiles and Apparel, Department of Commerce
Peckham
Pinnacle Textile Industries, LLC
PremiumEStore LLC, d.b.a. Premium-PPE
Reshoring Textiles, LLC DBA SPINNERE
Salute Industries Inc.
Samtech dba Massif
Sarratt Acquisition Management Inc.
SMART PROCUREMENT SOLUTIONS INC
SMI (for New Balance)
SNC Technical Services, LLC
Soie Clothing, LLC
SOURCEAMERICA
Sweet Mass Production, LLC
US Army, T2COM, DEVCOM-Soldier Center
United States Department of Agriculture (USDA)
VELCRO USA INC
Warrior Protection & Readiness Coalition (WPRC)
Workwear Outfitters (WWOF)



Industry Day

DOI Uniform Requirement

March 27, 2026

Current Uniform Contract

Indefinite delivery,
indefinite quantity
(IDIQ) contract.

Solicited as Full and
Open Competition
with a subcontracting
plan.

Solicited under FAR
Parts 12 and 15 in
FY22.

Uses Firm Fixed Priced
Task Orders based on
Employee Allowance
or bulk orders of
specific items.

Currently almost 1,000
individual items.

\$130M IDIQ total
ceiling over 5 years.

Participants

- National Park Service
- Bureau of Land Management
- Bureau of Reclamation
- Bureau of Safety and Environmental Enforcement
- U.S. Army Corps of Engineers
- U.S. Park Police
- U.S. Fish and Wildlife Service



US Army Corps
of Engineers®



Bureau Information

Bureau	Approximate number of Uniformed Employees	Locations
NPS	12,000 full-time and 8,000 seasonal	420 units worldwide
BLM	4,000	195 offices in the continental United States (CONUS) and Alaska
BOR	300	289 sites in CONUS and Alaska
BSEE	20	state and federal offshore waters of the U.S.
USACE	2,600 permanent and 1,200 seasonal	U.S.
USPP	700+ law enforcement personnel	Washington DC, New York City, and San Francisco
USFWS	6,500, includes full-time and seasonal	750 sites in CONUS and Alaska

Employee Duty Stations

- Extremely Cold Climates (Alaska, Montana, North Dakota)
- Extremely Hot Climates (deserts)
- Tropical Climates (Florida, Caribbean, American Samoa)
- Remote and very remote areas for deliveries
- Requires a modern flexible approach to fabrics, patterns, and finishing

DOI Uniform Requirement

The current award provides a full service one-stop-shop for:

- Civilian uniforms, patches, insignia, headwear, footwear, outerwear, and related items, customized for each bureau;
- Program and contract management;
- Product inventory management;
- Uniform service operations, such as sourcing, first article testing, warehousing, kitting, shipping, and customization; and
- Customer service.

DOI Uniform Requirement

The current IDIQ requires the contractor to provide a secure, web-based uniform ordering and account management system (WBOS) that can process:

- Orders
- Returns, exchanges, and cancellations
- Adding, replacing, and/or selling discontinued items as needed
- Payments from employee allowances (authorized on Task Orders), government charge cards, and personal credit or debit cards
- Reporting

Task Order Management

Currently in Pricing
Period 4; 5-year
ordering period
ends 9/27/28

USFW and BLM
typically issue
multiple task
orders

NPS, USACE, and
USPP typically
issue 1 task order
each per year

BSEE and BOR
typically issue
item-specific task
orders

Industry Day Objectives



Open exchange of
ideas with industry
partners



Seek industry
expertise to help
understand and
refine
requirements



Ensure strategy
promotes a robust
and fair
competition



Address industry
questions and
concerns



Obtain market
knowledge for this
requirement

Conclusion

- DOI Contracting intends to hold one-on-one virtual meetings with interested companies in the near future.
- Stop by the Contracting table after the break for more information.
- Panel discussion: Open forum seeking industry input.
- Industry questions will be answered to the best of the participants' current understanding of plans, objectives, and general situation. No information will be contractually binding.

Disclaimer - Market Research Only

- This presentation and panel discussion are for market research purposes.
- This is not a solicitation and does not constitute a request for proposals, quotes, or bids.
- The Government is not obligated to award a contract based on this information.
- Any information provided by industry is voluntary and will be used to inform acquisition planning.
- The Government will not reimburse any costs associated with attending this Industry Day.
- Responses may be used to help determine acquisition strategy, small business participation, and Buy American considerations.